

Session 1: Orientation

The focus of this course is to develop and support culturally responsive mentors. In order to build a supportive and trusting community in which to do this, we will spend some time getting to know one another. We will use our first week together for introductions and for an opportunity to share our own mentoring experiences and goals. This will also provide an opportunity to discuss the overall format of the course and expectations for dialogue.

Things for facilitators to be prepared for:

This session is primarily about building trust, setting expectations, and establishing a learning community. Since this is the participant's first impression of the course, facilitators should establish an environment where people feel comfortable participating.

Facilitators should encourage asking the participants to take turns reading out the community guidelines. Ask them to raise their zoom hand and call them in turn. Be sure to tell them where to find the Zoom hand (in the reactions menu) and to react to one another using emojis. If they feel comfortable, Facilitators can join the round robin breakout rooms. If they are identified as "hosts" in Zoom, they won't automatically be sent to a breakout room, but they can choose to join them.

Participant Pre-Work:

- **Objective:** Familiarity with the different roles a mentor may have, strategies a mentor may use to reach mentees, impacts that mentors have on mentees
- **Activities:**
 - **Pre-survey:** Complete the anonymous [pre-assessment survey](#)
 - **Intake Form:** Complete the [participant intake form](#)

Synchronous Session:

- **Materials Needed:**
 - [Community Guidelines](#)
 - [Land Acknowledgement](#)
 - [SI-MI Schedule Overview](#)
 - [Session 1 Survey](#)
 - Access to Zoom and familiarity with creating break-out rooms.
- **Learning Objectives:**
 - **Objective 1:** Participants will gain a deeper understanding of the course structure and expectations.
 - **Objective 2:** Participants will get to know one another.

- **Objective 3:** Participants will build trust as the positives and negatives of mentoring are shared.
- **Prework for Facilitator 2:**
 - Set all observers/facilitators as hosts (unless you want to be assigned to breakout rooms). Note: Some facilitators (maybe **Facilitators 2** and **3**) could join the participants in the Round Robin introductions. Previous facilitators found that it is a good way to get to know the participants.
 - Set up first breakout rooms, random assignment of pairs, auto-recall of 5 minutes.
 - Note: **Facilitator 2** could create an extra room that no one is using in case some facilitators want to participate in the Round Robin breakout rooms.
 - Set up screen with 5 min google timer, ready to share
 - **Facilitator 2** will start the recording; **Facilitator 3** backs up at starting/stopping recording for breakouts
- Note for all facilitators: make sure to rename yourself as “Facilitator” in the Zoom name.

Live Session Agenda:

- **Welcome and warm-up activity: 00:00 - 00:05 (5 minutes)**
 - **Activity Type:** Synchronous discussion
 - **Description:** Facilitators introduce themselves and the course.
 - **Facilitator 3: Start recording**
 - **Facilitator 2** posts to chat: “Introduce yourself in the chat: name, pronouns, current place of work, and one reason for taking the course. Your introductions will be saved to a Google Doc to be shared with the rest of the class. This will only be shared within the cohort.”
- **Course Overview and Community Principles: 00:05 - 00:25 (20 minutes)**
 - **Activity Type:** Facilitator Presentation
 - **Description:**
 - **Facilitator 1** provides a [land acknowledgement](#) for R&S headquarters and an Indigenous-led organization that folks can support. **Facilitator 2** shares the land acknowledgement on the screen and pastes the [land acknowledgement](#) slide in the chat.
 - **Facilitator 1** reviews the structure of the course, and expectations. **Facilitator 2** shares the [schedule overview](#) on the screen and in chat. **Facilitator 1** shares that participants will receive an email after each session with their homework, and that after each session there will be a short questionnaire for feedback. Participants should take two minutes to complete it while the session is fresh in their mind; it should take about five minutes.
 - **Facilitator 2** shares the [community guidelines](#) on the screen and pastes the link in the chat. Facilitator(s) also emphasize the culture of the course and why vulnerability is important. Participants are

able to ask questions about the course, and are given a chance to add any guidelines that are not included in the provided list.

Note: Each participant can read one of the community guidelines out loud, which increases participation and attention. Ask participants who want to read to raise their hands. The facilitator can call on volunteers.

- **BREAK: 00:25 - 00:30 (5 min)**
 - **Facilitator 2** shares their screen with the timer countdown and takes [attendance](#).
 - **Facilitator 2** copies the participant introduction from the intro activity and posts it in the [participant introductions document](#).
 - **Facilitator 3:** Stop recording during break, restarts recording after break
- **Intro Round Robin: 00:30 - 00:55 (25 minutes)**
 - **Activity Type:** Pair Breakouts
 - **Questions: (Facilitator 2: Share in chat before the break):**
 - Round 1: What activity or hobby makes you feel joy?
 - Round 2: What place feels the most like home?
 - Round 3: What life lesson are you learning right now?
 - Stop recording during breakout, start recording after breakout
 - **Description:** **Facilitator 2** will create randomly assigned breakout rooms for participants to get to know each other informally. Breakout rooms are reassigned every 6 minutes, so 00:36, 00:42, 00:48. Give a 2 - minute warning for each switch. Facilitators may join breakout rooms as co-learners in the experience.
- **Break: 00:55 - 01:00 (5 minutes)** **Facilitator 2** will share the screen with a timer countdown. **Facilitator 3:** Stop recording during break, start recording after break
- **Mentoring Round Robin: 01:00 - 01:25 (25 minutes)**
 - **Activity Type:** Pair Breakouts
 - **Facilitator 3:** Stop recording during the breakout, start recording after the breakout
 - **Description:** **Facilitator 2** will create randomly assigned breakout rooms to discuss questions about mentoring and get to know other participants. Breakout rooms are reassigned every 6 minutes, so 01:07, 01:13, 01:19. Broadcast a 2-minute warning before each switch. Facilitators may join breakout rooms as co-learners in the experience.
 - **Questions (Facilitator 2 will share in chat before the break):**
 - Round 1: What qualities does your ideal mentor have?
 - Round 2: What is one thing that you've never forgotten from your most positive mentoring experience?
 - Round 3: What is one thing that you've never forgotten from your most negative mentoring experience?
- **Large Group Share-Out: 01:25 - 1:29 (4 minutes)**

- **Activity Type:** **Facilitator 1** leads participants in taking turns sharing something positive they learned about their breakout partners in the chat, with 1-2 people on the mic. They may also share how the activity made them feel (anxious? awkward? grateful? connected?).
 - **Wrap-Up: 01:29 - 01:30 (1 minute)**
 - **Description:** **Facilitator 1** thanks the participants for showing up, being vulnerable, and trusting the process. Facilitator(s) tell participants to look out for an email about the next homework.
 - **Facilitator 2** shares the link to [Session 1 Survey](#) in chat, and asks participants to complete ASAP.
 - **Facilitator 3** stops the recording.
-

Facilitator Notes:

The Facilitators should spend time writing down everything they observed during the session (what worked, what didn't, and what improvements need to be made). They can also include advice for the next facilitator to watch out for. Facilitators may use the following guiding questions:

- How did the session go?
- Was there active participation in discussions?
- Do you feel like the learning objectives were met?
- Are there topics that need to be revisited in the next session?
- Were participants fully engaged when discussing their own mentoring experiences or goals?
- Were there times of vulnerability, disagreement, or hesitation? How were they managed?
- Did the conversation about group norms seem genuine and open? Were any important issues addressed?
- Are there any organizational improvements (tech, timing, breakout structure) to be addressed before the next session?